



DR. NARESH TREHAN

CHAIRMAN & MANAGING
DIRECTOR, MEDANTA

(FY26 REVENUE: ₹4,410 CR)

Dr. Naresh Trehan has combined clinical practice with institution building across a career spanning nearly five decades. After a surgical career in the United States, he returned to India determined to create a healthcare institution integrating clinical care, technology, research and medical education. He founded Escorts Heart Institute in the late 1980s. In 2009, he founded Medanta, which has since grown into a multi-specialty healthcare network with hospitals in Gurugram, Lucknow, Patna, Indore and Ranchi, alongside a facility in Noida.

India in 1989 with a specific irritation. He had watched even a country as rich as the United States fail to make healthcare affordable, and he did not see why India should assume its own growing wealth would fix the problem on its own. "My only objective was to bring down the cost of heart care for the common man in the country," he says of the decision that shaped the rest of his career.

Narayana's first hospital, the Rabindranath Tagore International Institute of Cardiac Sciences, opened in Kolkata in 2000 with a modest initial investment of ₹1.6 lakh. A larger, 225-bed cardiac hospital followed in Bengaluru the next year. The arithmetic worked on volume: a high number of surgeries, standardised processes, and a sharp reduction in the cost per procedure. A heart surgery that can run to ₹30 lakh or more in the United States costs between ₹1 lakh and ₹2 lakh at Narayana.

Dr. Shetty is characteristically blunt about why the group grew as fast as it did. "When the sea level rises, big ships go up, and so do the small boats," he says.

In January 2024, Narayana Health Insurance received its licence from the insurance regulator, making the group the first Indian hospital chain to launch its own insurance arm. Dr. Shetty has also flagged a growing worry about India's dependence on imported medical equip-



"The market in North India was severely underserved. The region accounts for roughly 60% of the population but a much smaller share of its organised healthcare"

DR. DHARMINDER NAGAR

MANAGING DIRECTOR, PARAS HEALTH